INCH-POUND
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28 March 2024
SUPERSEDING
A-A-55190
29 March 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SEWING KIT

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description (CID) by all federal agencies in preference to MIL-S-3276.

1. SCOPE. This CID covers the requirements for a sewing kit with contents intended for use by the military for repairing clothing.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The sewing kit shall be of one (1) type and the contents of each kit shall be classified as follows:

2.1 Classes.

Class 1 – Army

Style 1 – Male
Style 2 – Female

Class 2 – Air Force

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FSC 8315

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3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Material. The kit shall be a one-piece type made from vinyl chloride film with an upper and lower pocket and an inserted felt pad. It is closed by folding on itself and secured by means of a snap fastener. The basic materials shall be:

(a) Colorless, flexible, vinyl chloride film with a minimum 0.020 inches thickness in accordance with ASTM D374 Method C. The film may have a smooth dull matte finish on both sides, or one or both sides may be planished.

(b) Felt for inside flap of kit shall be at least 45% wool according to AATCC 20A, 0.065 inches thick, according to ASTM D1777, weigh 6.0 ounces per square yard according to ASTM D3376; and with 8.0 pound breaking strength according to ASTM D5034. As an alternate, a 100 percent polyester needle punched nonwoven material weighing from 8.0 to 10.0 ounces per square yard and with a thickness of from 0.070 to 0.95 inches, may be used. 1/

(c) Snap fasteners shall be pronged ring head type with a black finish conforming to MIL-DTL-10884.

(d) Polyethylene bag to hold contents.

1/ Ten 2 by 6 inch specimens shall be cut with a die from each test sample, five take lengthwise and five crosswise of the piece. The jaws of the clamps shall be not less than 2 inches in width. The thickness of each specimen shall be measured and the cross- sectional area of each specimen shall be calculated before testing. The testing strength shall equal the breaking load divided by the cross-sectional area.

3.1.1 Component parts cut/assembly. The component parts of the kit shall be cut and assembled to conform with measurements shown in Figures 1 and 2. To the extent of any inconsistencies between the written document and the figures, the written document shall govern.

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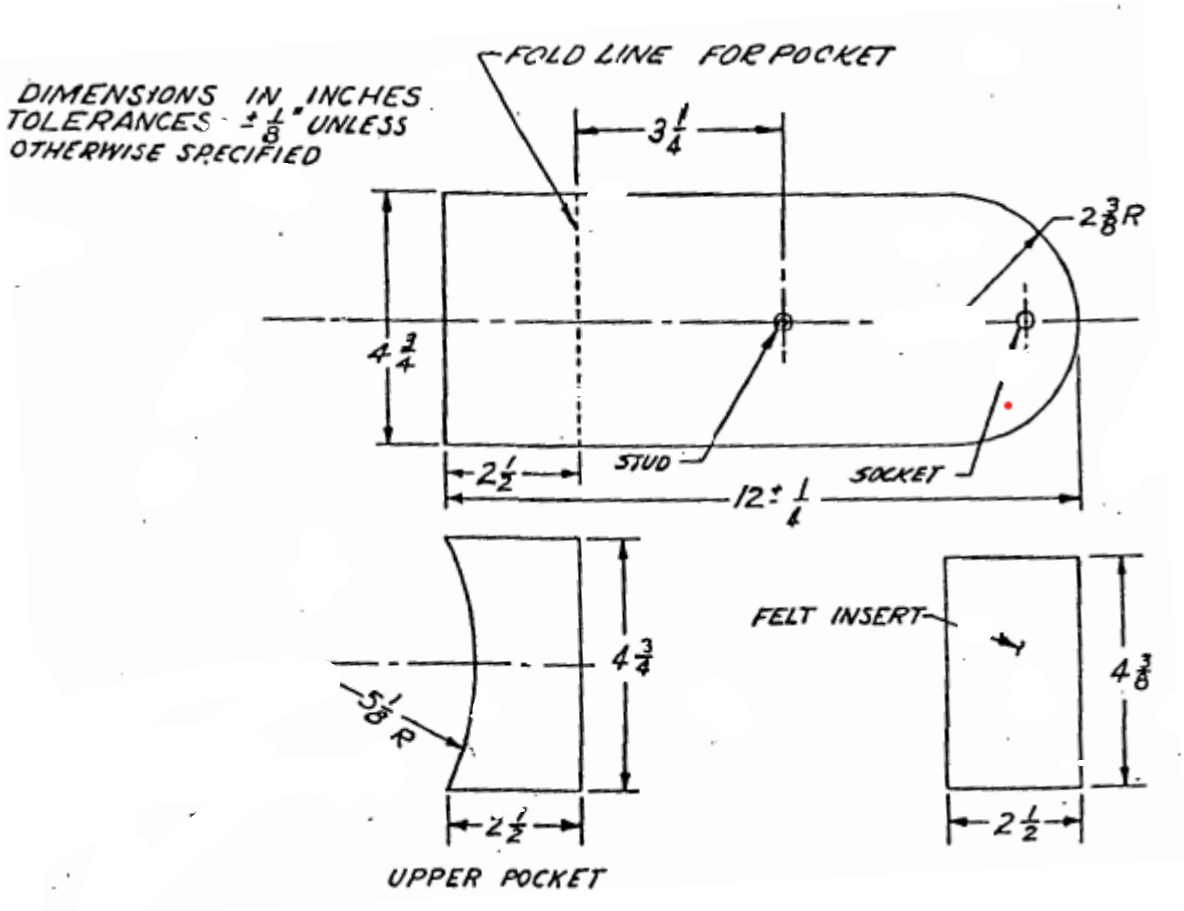


FIGURE 1. Sewing kit.

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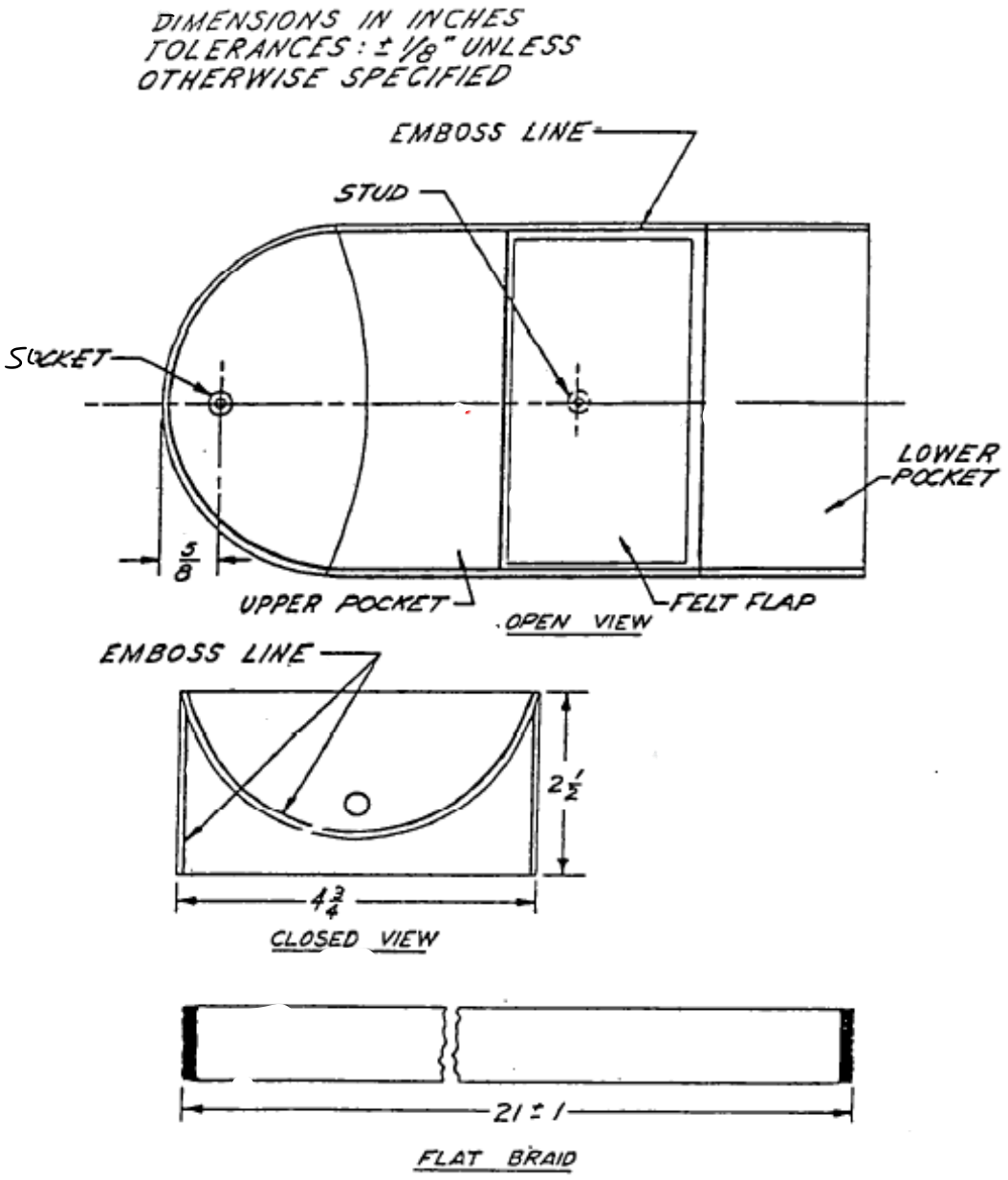


FIGURE 2. Sewing kit.

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3.1.2 Contents of kit. The kits shall contain the following items:

(a) 14 safety pins, without guards, in commercial sizes 1, 2, and 3 (10 of size 1 mounted on a card)

(b) 8 steel, nickel plated hand sewing needles in commercial sizes 2 and 4 (4 each size)

(c) Assorted buttons as shown in the tables below. The metal uniform buttons shall conform to Type I, Style 2, Class A or B of MIL-B-3461. The size 25 line buttons shall have a short shank or hopper back and the 36-line buttons shall have a hopper back. The plastic buttons for all colors shall conform to Type II, Class D of A-A-59994, except the Polyester White BA buttons, listed in Table III, which shall be Class K.

(d) The thread in the braids shall conform to Type I, cotton covered or Type II, polyester covered, TEX Size 36-45, 2 ply conforming to A-A-50199. The thread shall have a minimum breaking strength of 3.2. Colorfastness requirements in A-A-50199 shall apply. Each thread in the braid shall be not less than 24 inches long and the braid itself shall be 21± 1 inches long. The braid shall be of sufficient looseness to permit the withdrawal of a single thread without difficulty. The number of carriers and ends per carrier shall be as indicated in the tables.

(e) Seam ripper, overall length shall not exceed 4 inches and the blade shall be one (1) inch minimum.

TABLE I. Army (Male).

Buttons	Quantity	Style	Size	Color
Plastic	6	26	30	Foliage Green 504
	2	20 or 21	24	Black BT
	2	20 or 21	30	Black BT
	2	20 or 21	45	Black BT
	2	15	18	Black BT
	2	4	22	Army Green 489
	2	4	22	Army Blue 451
	4	25	19	White BA
Metal (uniform)	2	2, Class A or B	36	Gold Plated
	2	2, Class A or B	25	Gold Plated
Braided thread	Number of Carriers	Ends per Carrier		Color
	6	6		Foliage Green 504
	8	6		Black AA
	7	6		Bleached White AH
	4	6		Army Blue 450
	4	6		Army Blue 451

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TABLE II. Army (Female).

Buttons	Quantity	Style	Size	Color
Plastic	6	26	30	Foliage Green 504
	2	20 or 21	24	Army Green 489
	2	20 or 21	24	Army Blue 451
	2	20 or 21	24	Army Blue 450
	2	20 or 21	24	Black BT
	2	20 or 21	30	Black BT
	2	20 or 21	45	Black BT
	4	15	18	Black BT
		25	19	White BA
Metal (uniform)	2	2, Class A or B	30	Gold Plated
	2	2, Class A or B	25	Gold Plated
Braided thread	Number of Carriers	Ends per Carrier		Color
	6	6		Foliage Green 504
	8	6		Black AA
	7	6		Bleached White AH
	4	6		Army Blue 450
	4	6		Army Blue 451

TABLE III. Air Force.

Buttons	Quantity	Style	Size	Color and Cable Number
Plastic	2	20 or 21	40	Blue BU 62002
	4	20 or 21	24	Blue BU 62002
	1	20 or 21	30	Blue BU 62002
	2	4	22	Blue BV 62003
	2	20 or 21	24	Blue BV 62003
	2	24	20	Blue BV 62003
	6	26	30	Olive Green BP 62016 dull
	10	25	19	Poly White BA 62031
Braided thread	Number of Carriers	Size (line)		Color and Cable Number
	5	6		Blue M 66027
	8	6		Navy Blue AT 66060
	8	6		Olive Drab S-1 66022
	8	6		White AH 66050

3.1.2.1 Buttons. Buttons for each kit shall be packaged in a polyethylene bag and placed in the lower pocket of the kit. The bag shall be closed by folding back the unfilled portion of the bag.

3.1.2.2 Braided thread. The braided thread shall be folded and inserted into the upper pocket of the kit.

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3.1.2.3 Seam ripper. The seam ripper shall be placed in the upper pocket of the kit below the braided thread.

3.1.2.4 Safety pins. The card with the safety pins (size 1) shall be placed in the upper pocket of the kit behind the braid with the back of the card next to the kit. The size 2 and size 3 safety pins shall be pinned to the felt strip parallel to the top and bottom of the kit.

3.1.2.5 Needles. The four needles of each size shall be attached to the felt strip parallel to the top and bottom of the kit.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 Vinyl chloride film. The vinyl chloride film shall be 12 inches long (±1/4") and 4-3/4 inches wide with a 2-3/8 inch radius curve on one end.

3.2.2 Upper pocket. The upper pocket shall be positioned on the curved end of the body piece with the side edges of the pocket even with the side edges of the body piece.

3.2.3 Felt pad. The felt pad shall be inserted under the bottom edge of the upper pocket for a distance of 1/4 to 3/8 inches.

3.2.4 Upper pocket and body piece. The bottom edge of the upper pocket and the body piece shall be heat sealed to the felt pad with a 1/8 inch minimum seal in such a manner as to hold the pad securely in place. The bottom end of the body piece shall be turned up 2-1/2 inches from the straight end of the vinyl forming the lower pocket or the lower pocket may be a separate piece 4-3/4 inches by 2-1/2 inches.

3.2.5 Side edges. The side edges of the upper and lower pocket and the bottom edge of the lower pocket, if a separate piece, shall be heat sealed using a 1/8 to 3/16 inch wide heat seal.

3.2.6 Heat seal bond. The strength of the heat seal bond shall not be less than 22 pounds when tested as specified under End Item Performance Testing.

3.2.7 Outside edges. The outside edges of the finished kit shall be embossed but not more than 3/16 inches from the edge.

3.2.8 Snap fasteners. The snap fasteners shall be attached with the female 5/8 inches from the center of the curved end and the male 3/4 inch from the folded lower pocket.

3.3 Toxicity. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or procurement documents, the finished sewing kit shall not present a health hazard and shall show compatibility with prolonged, direct skin contact when tested as specified in 3.31.

3.31 Toxicity test. When the toxicity requirement (see 3.3) can be demonstrated with historical use data, on the finishing treatments used, toxicity testing may not be required, (see 7.1.4 and 7.4).

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3.4 End item performance testing. The end item shall be tested for bonding strength of seal. The bonding strength of seal shall be determined as specified in ASTM D882 except that no autographic stress-strain curve is required. The test specimens shall be one inch wide with the seam in the center of the specimen. The free ends of the specimen shall be clamped, (one in each jaw) in the testing machine. The sample unit shall be one (1) kit without contents. A lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet the heat seal requirement of 22 pounds. Lot sizes (kits) are as follows: 800 or less, sample size is 20 sample units; 801 to 22,000, sample size is 27 sample units; 22,001 and over, sample size is 45 sample units.

3.5 Workmanship. After completion, the finished sewing kit shall be thoroughly cleaned, and foreign matter removed. The sewing kit shall conform to the quality of the product established in this document. The sewing kit shall be free from defects which would affect its serviceability, appearance, uniformity and quality assurance standards defined by the technical data in the procurement documents.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. Unless otherwise specified, the offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered, recycled, bio based, and environmentally preferable materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403, 23.404(b) of the Federal Acquisition Regulation FAR, or the sustainable acquisition of EO 13693; as applicable. (see 7.1.2).

5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The sewing kit shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Market acceptability. The finished sewing kit offered must have been sold to the government or commercial market.

5.3 End item inspection procedures. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection of Attributes (see 7.2.2).

5.4 Visual examination. Each finished sewing kit shall be examined for the defects listed in Table IV as defined in ASTM D3990. The lot size shall be expressed in units of sewing kits. The sample unit shall be one (1) sewing kit. The inspection level shall be I and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.5.

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TABLE IV. Visual examination defects.

Material defects: Material (plastic film) – cut, tear, or hole; scratch, crease or blister more than 1/4 inch in diameter or length; spot, stain, or imbedded foreign matter more than 1/4 inch in diameter; does not have a smooth dull matte finish on both sides.
Stitches, seams and stitching: Any seam not completely sealed, any component missing, seam construction not as specified, any seam puckered or distorted in heat sealing.
Workmanship: Kit (complete with contents) cannot be folded on itself and snapped satisfactorily, felt pad not completely caught in seam or not securely held in place, plastic or metal buttons not in conformance with type, class and style specified or nicked, cracked, disfigured, or malformed, entire braid missing, finished length less than 20 inches or more than 22 inches; safety pins malformed or damaged; needles omitted or corroded.
Labels: Label(s) missing, incorrect, or illegible; bar code or UPC code label omitted or not readable by scanner; human-readable interpretation (HRI) omitted or illegible; bar code not visible on folded packaged item, bar code label causes damage to the item.
Packaging: The fully packaged shipping containers shall be examined in accordance with defects: for material, the defects are material that is missing, damaged or not as specified; for content, the defects are the number of sewing kits per shipping container is more or less than required. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and AQL expressed in terms of defects per hundred units shall be 1.5.

5.5 Dimensional examination. The finished sewing kit shall conform to the dimensions specified in Figures I and II when measured as stated. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit shall be one (1) sewing kit; the inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL expressed in terms of defects per hundred units shall be 2.5.

5.6 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or procurement documents (see 7.5).

6. PACKAGING. The preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 7.5).

7. NOTES.

7.1 Source of Government documents:

7.1.1 Copies of Government documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.

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7.1.2 EPA and EO 13693 information is available online at https://www.epa.gov.

7.1.3 Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR) are available online at https://acquisition.gov.

7.1.4 Toxicity testing. If dermal toxicity testing is required, it will be conducted in accordance with Title 40, Protection of Environment, Code of Federal Regulations current edition and applicable sections, which are also consistent with the following OECD tests:

Skin Sensitization 406 and Dermal Irritation 404 (https://www.oecd-ilibrary.org/environment/oecd-guidelines-for-the-testing-of-chemicals-section-4-health-effects_20745788?page=1).
Dermal Sensitization (https://www.law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/40/798.4100).
Dermal Toxicity (https://www.law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/40/798.2250).

7.2 Source of non-Government documents.

7.2.1 AATCC Test Methods are available for purchase online at https://aatcc.org.

7.2.2 ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 – Sampling Procedures are available online at https://asq.org.

7.2.3 ASTM Standards are available for purchase online https://www.astm.org.

7.3 Intended use. The sewing kit is intended for use by the military for repairing clothing.

7.4 Certificate of compliance. The contracting activity may select to accept a certificate of compliance for a stated requirement.

7.5 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this CID.
b. Type and classes required (see 2.).
c. Color required (see 3.1).
d. When toxicity testing is required (see 3.3).
e. Product conformance (see 5.1).
f. Acceptance criteria (see 5.6).
g. Packaging requirements (see 6.).

7.6 National Stock Number (NSNs). The following is a list of NSNs assigned that correspond to this CID. This list may not be indicative of all possible NSNs associated with the CID and are provided for reference only.

NSN - 8315-01-222-0680

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7.7 Key words.

Apparel
Needlework
Seamstress's
Stitching
Tailor's
Textile

MILITARY INTERESTS:

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTVITY:
GSA-FAS

Custodians:
Army - GL
Air Force - 11

Preparing Activity
DLA-CT

(Project: 8315-2024-007)

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